

Lecture 3

Accessing Arrays using Pointers

Original author of the slides is Jawad Hassan, FAST-NUCES, Islamabad but slides have been modified time by time as per the requirements of the class.

Relationship Between Pointers and Arrays

- Arrays and pointers are closely related
- Arrays are laid out sequentially in memory
- By using the address-of operator (&), we can determine that arrays are laid out

sequentially in memory. For example,

```
int array[5] = { 9, 7, 5, 3, 1 };  
std::cout << "Element 0 is at address: " << &array[0] <<  
'\n'; std::cout << "Element 1 is at address: " << &array[1]  
<< '\n';  
std::cout << "Element 2 is at address: " << &array[2] << '\n';  
std::cout << "Element 3 is at address: " << &array[3] << '\n';
```

- Each of these memory addresses is 4 bytes apart, which is the size of an integer

Relationship Between Pointers and Arrays (Cont.)

- Accessing array elements with pointers

- Assume declarations:

```
int List[5]; //declare array
int *LPtr;   //declare a pointer
LPtr = List; // Address of first Element of array List
```

Effect:-

- List is an address, no need for &
- The LPtr pointer will contain the address of the first element of
array List.

- Element **List[2]** can be accessed by ***(LPtr + 2)**

Accessing 1-Demensional Array Using

Pointers

- We know Array name denotes the memory address of its first slot.

- Example:

- `int List [ 50 ];`

- `int *Pointer;`

- `Pointer = List; //stores address of the first element in Pointer`

- Other slots of the Array (List [50]) can be accessed using by performing Arithmetic operations on Pointer.

- For example the address of (element 4th) can be accessed using:-

- `int *Value = Pointer + 3;`

- The value of (element 4th) can be accessed using:-

- `int Value = *(Pointer + 3);`

Address	Data
980	Element 0
982	Element 1
984	Element 2
986	Element 3
988	Element 4
990	Element 5
992	Element 6
994	Element 7
996	Element 8
...	
...	
998	Element 50

Accessing 1-Demensional Array

```
....  
....  
    int List [ 50 ];  
    int *Pointer;  
    Pointer = List; // Address of first  
                    Element  
  
    int *ptr;  
    cout<<*ptr; //what will it display?  
    *ptr is equivalent to List[0]  
  
    ptr = Pointer + 3; // Address of 4th Element  
  
    *ptr = 293; // 293 value store at 4th element  
                address
```

Address	Data
980	Element 0
982	Element 1
984	Element 2
986	293
988	Element 4
990	Element 5
992	Element 6
994	Element 7
996	Element 8
...	
...	
998	Element 50

Accessing 1-Dimensional Array

We can access all element of List [50]
using Pointers and for loop combinations.

```
...  
...  
    int List [ 50 ];  
    int *Pointer;  
    Pointer =  
    List;  
    for ( int i = 0; i < 50; i++ )  
    {  
        cout << *Pointer;  
        Pointer++; // Address of next  
                   element  
    }  
}
```



This is Equivalent to

```
for ( int loop = 0; loop < 50; loop++ )  
    cout <<    Array [ loop ] ;
```

Address	Data
980	Element 0
982	Element 1
984	Element 2
986	Element 3
988	Element 4
990	Element 5
992	Element 6
994	Element 7
996	Element 8
...	
...	
998	Element 50

Question 1

What will be the output?

```
int x = 10;
```

```
int *p = &x;
```

```
cout << x << endl;
```

```
cout << *p << endl;
```

Solution 1

10
10

Question 2

What will be the output?

```
int x = 10;
```

```
int *p = &x;
```

```
*p = 25;
```

```
cout << x << endl;
```

```
cout << *p << endl;
```

Solution 2

25

25

Question 3

Consider:

```
int num = 50;
```

```
int *ptr = &num;
```

Identify what each expression represents:

num

&num

ptr

*ptr

&ptr

Solution 3

Expression	Meaning
num	Value of num → 50
&num	Address of num
ptr	Address stored in ptr → address of num
*ptr	Value at that address → 50
&ptr	Address of the pointer variable itself

Question 4

Find the error in the following code:

```
int x;  
int *p;
```

```
*p = 100;
```

```
cout << x;
```

Solution 4

The pointer p has not been initialized.

Question 5

What is the output?

```
int x = 10;
```

```
int y = 20;
```

```
int *p = &x;
```

```
*p = y;
```

```
cout << x << endl;
```

```
cout << y << endl;
```

Solution 5

20

20

Question 6

What will be printed?

```
int x = 50;
```

```
int *p1 = &x;
```

```
int *p2 = &x;
```

```
*p1 = 100;
```

```
cout << *p2 << endl;
```

```
cout << x << endl;
```

Solution 6

100

100

Question 7

Consider:

```
int x = 10;  
int *p = &x;
```

```
p = nullptr;
```

What happens to x?

What happens to p?

Solution 7

x remains:10

p becomes: nullptr

Question 8

Consider:

```
int arr[5] = {10, 20, 30, 40, 50};
```

What are the values of:

arr[0]

arr[2]

arr[4]

Solution 8

arr[0] = 10

arr[2] = 30

arr[4] = 50

Question 9

What will be the output?

```
int arr[5] = {10, 20, 30, 40, 50};
```

```
int *p = arr;
```

```
cout << *p << endl;
```

Solution 9

10

Question 10

What will be the output?

```
int arr[5] = {10, 20, 30, 40, 50};
```

```
int *p = arr;
```

```
cout << *(p + 2);
```

Solution 10

30

Question 11

Consider:

```
int arr[5] = {10, 20, 30, 40, 50};
```

```
int *p = arr;
```

Which expression gives the **address of the fourth element**?

Solution 11

A

$$*(p + 3)$$

B

$$p + 3$$

C

$$*p + 3$$

D

$$p + 4$$

Correct Answer

B

$$p + 3$$

Question 12

What will be the output?

```
int arr[5] = {10, 20, 30, 40, 50};
```

```
int *p = arr;
```

```
*(p + 2) = 100;
```

```
cout << arr[2];
```

Solution 12

100

Question 14

What will be printed?

```
int arr[4] = {10, 20, 30, 40};
```

```
int *p = arr;
```

```
cout << *p << endl;
```

```
p++;
```

```
cout << *p << endl;
```

Solution 14

10
20

Question 15

What is the final output?

```
int arr[5] = {10, 20, 30, 40, 50};
```

```
int *p = arr;
```

```
p++;
```

```
p++;
```

```
cout << *p;
```

Solution 15

30